

UVAN

ASIA MARKET ENTRY

Global Market Entry Audit 2026

A self-assessment framework for companies entering
or operating across the India / Asia corridor.

5 operational gaps. One readiness checklist. Built from 60,000+ hours
of on-the-ground market entry and boardroom interpretation work.

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WHY THIS AUDIT EXISTS

Five gaps that quietly derail expansion

In 60,000+ hours of on-the-ground market entry work and boardroom interpretation across the India / Asia corridor, the same five operational gaps appear again and again - regardless of sector, deal size, or country of origin. None of them are visible on a balance sheet until they have already cost time, capital, or trust. Use the checklist below as an honest self-assessment of where your organisation stands today.

1

Regulatory & Entity Infrastructure

The legal and compliance foundation that everything else in your market entry depends on.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

- We have confirmed the correct entity structure (subsidiary, branch office, liaison office, or JV) for our specific business activity in India.
- We understand the FEMA, RBI, and FDI policy requirements that apply to our sector.
- We have a registered, compliant office address and the statutory registrations (GST, PAN, TAN, shops & establishment) in place or mapped.
- We have a clear view of ongoing compliance obligations - filings, audits, secretarial requirements - and who owns them.

WHAT IT COSTS IF LEFT UNADDRESSED

Companies that skip this step typically discover the gap only when a bank account, contract, or hire stalls on missing paperwork - costing 3 to 6 months and, in some cases, regulatory penalties.

2

Partner Integrity Verification

Distributors, agents, and joint-venture partners who were never verified on the ground.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

- We have physically verified our distributor's or partner's premises, warehousing, and operational capacity - not just their paperwork.
- We have checked our partner's litigation history, financial standing, and reputation in-market through independent, local sources.
- Our contracts include enforceable performance, exclusivity, and exit clauses suited to Indian commercial law.
- We have an independent, on-ground point of contact who is not financially dependent on the partner relationship.

WHAT IT COSTS IF LEFT UNADDRESSED

Unverified partners are the single largest cause of failed India entries we have seen - misrepresented capacity, channel conflict, and disputes that take years and significant capital to unwind.

3

The Coordination Tax (Management Overhead)

The hidden cost of running cross-border operations without a dedicated, on-ground layer of management.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

- We have measured how many hours per week our HQ leadership spends on time-zone calls, translation, and follow-up for the India operation.
- We have a single, accountable point of contact in-market who can make day-to-day decisions without escalating every item to HQ.
- Our reporting cadence gives HQ visibility without requiring HQ involvement in every operational decision.
- We have quantified what HQ's time is worth and compared it to the cost of a dedicated on-ground liaison.

WHAT IT COSTS IF LEFT UNADDRESSED

Left unaddressed, this gap doesn't show up as a line item - it shows up as senior leadership time quietly consumed by operational firefighting, quarter after quarter.

4

Human Capital Strategy

Staffing, visas, and the local talent pipeline required to actually run the business.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

- We have a hiring plan that reflects realistic local salary benchmarks, notice periods, and statutory benefits (PF, gratuity, insurance).
- We understand the visa and work-authorization pathway for any expatriate staff we plan to deploy.
- We have a plan for managing labour law compliance as our local headcount grows.
- We have identified who will own HR and people operations on the ground - not just on an org chart.

WHAT IT COSTS IF LEFT UNADDRESSED

Companies that under-invest here lose their first 12 to 18 months to avoidable attrition, mis-hires, and compliance exposure that a local staffing strategy would have prevented.

5

Executive Liaison & Negotiation

High-stakes conversations - government, partners, boardrooms - conducted without on-ground authority or cultural fluency.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

- Our senior leadership has access to an experienced, trusted interpreter and cultural advisor for high-stakes meetings, not just a translation app.
- We have someone who can represent our interests credibly in a room - government liaison, partner negotiation, institutional relationship - when HQ cannot be physically present.
- We understand the cultural and protocol expectations specific to our sector and corridor (e.g., government, manufacturing, education).
- Our negotiation positions account for local business norms rather than assuming HQ's home-market playbook transfers directly.

WHAT IT COSTS IF LEFT UNADDRESSED

Decisions made in rooms without the right liaison present are the hardest to reverse - they shape partner trust, regulatory goodwill, and deal terms long after the meeting ends.

HOW TO READ YOUR RESULTS

Checked every box across all five gaps? Your organisation is in a strong position to move. Left several boxes unchecked? Those are not blockers - they are the exact items a structured entry roadmap is built to close, in sequence, before they become costly.

Ready to close these gaps?

Book a 30-minute India Entry Readiness Call. We'll assess your expansion goals, identify your highest-risk gaps from this audit, and give you a clear picture of what needs to be in place before you move.

BOOK YOUR INDIA ENTRY READINESS CALL →

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UVAN — Asia Market Entry. Language meets operations across the India / Asia corridor.